Team Rules for OpenAI Codex with AGENTS.md



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Overview

Same review comments, every PR

```
+ def apply_coupon(total, code):
+     if code not in COUPONS:
+         raise ValueError("bad coupon")
```

Reviewer: "We use AppError codes. Where are the tests?
And please update CHANGELOG.md." (again)

Write rules once → **Codex reads them** → **Fewer repeat fixes**

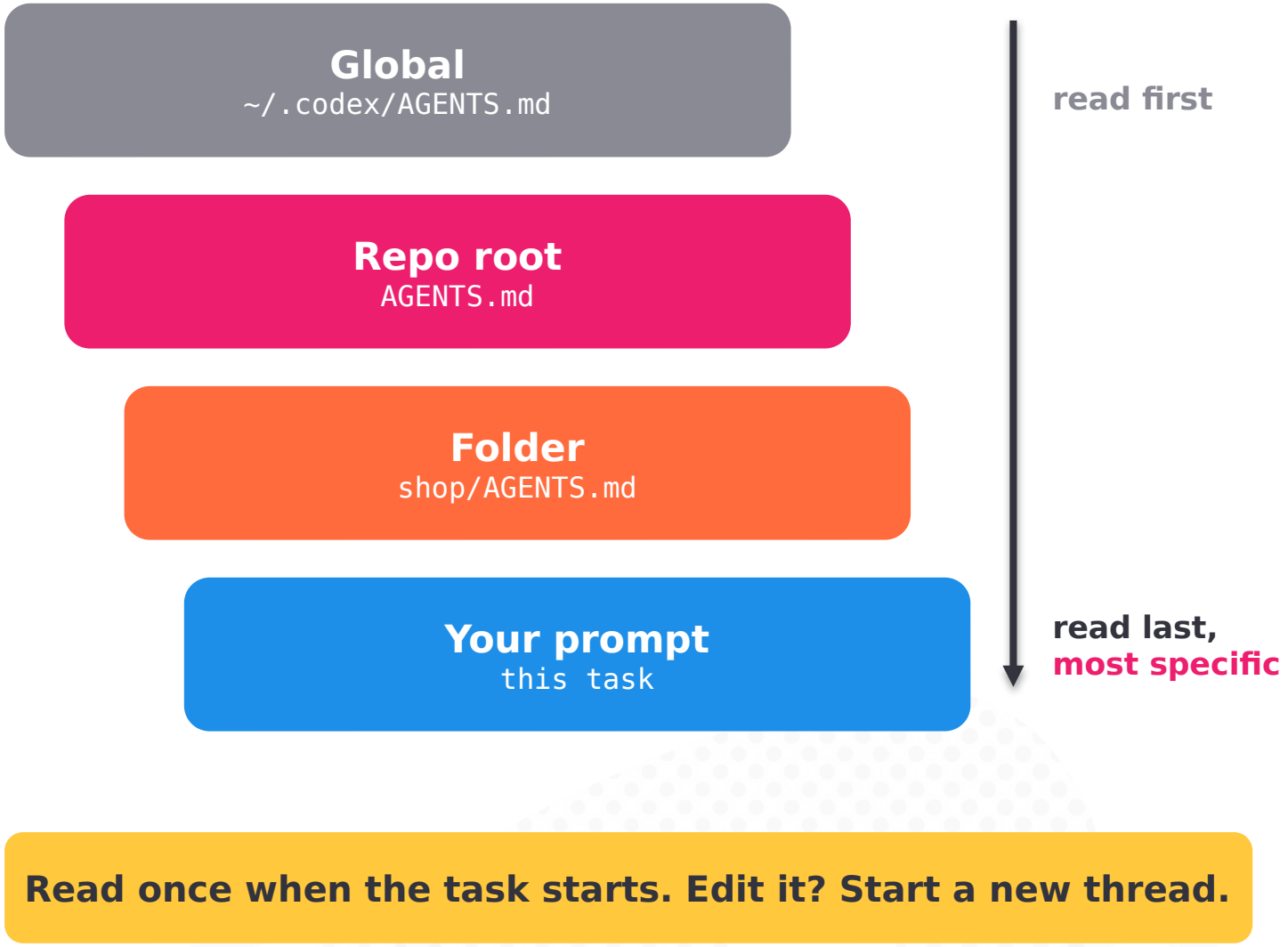
Your takeaway: put your team's conventions where Codex reads them on every task.

Where AGENTS.md files live

Location	Use it for
`~/.codex/AGENTS.md`	Your personal defaults, every repo
`<repo root>/AGENTS.md`	The team's shared rules, in Git ← today's demo
`<repo>/shop/AGENTS.md`	Extra rules for one folder
`32 KiB combined`	Default size limit: keep rules short

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How Codex combines the rules



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Priya's AGENTS.md

```
# Bookshop team rules
- Money is Decimal, never float
- Invalid input: raise AppError
  with an UPPER_SNAKE code
- Docstring with an Example: line
- Tests in tests/test_<module>.py
- Run: python -m unittest
    discover -s tests -v
- One line in CHANGELOG.md
- No new dependencies
```

CODE
how we write it

TESTS
how we prove it

HOUSEKEEPING
what else changes

Concrete, checkable rules. "Write clean code" does nothing.

Demo

What we'll do in Priya's repo

1. **WITHOUT RULES**
   Ask Codex to add apply_coupon
2. **SPOT THE GAPS**
   Review the diff against team rules
3. **ADD AGENTS.md**
   Copy the rules file to the repo root
4. **SAME TASK AGAIN**
   Reset, new thread, same prompt
5. **COMPARE**
   AppError, tests, changelog in the diff

Summary

Write team rules once, in the repo

Specific rules change the diff

Closer files add detail

Rules guide Codex. Review still checks

Your first AGENTS.md

What do you correct in every code review?

Those are your first three rules.



Commit it, so every teammate and every thread gets it.